Human-made Things in the Bible © United Bible Societies, 2025. Adapted from: The Works of Their Hands: Man-made Things in the Bible, by Ray Pritz © 2009 United Bible Societies. This work is licensed under Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0 International (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/4.0/).

Spearhead

2.5.1 Spearhead

References:

Hebrew לְהָבָה (lehavah) 1SA 17:7

Hebrew קַיִן (qayin) 2SA 21:16

Description and usage:

Bronze spearhead from Iran, Luristan, ca 1000–550 BCE (Los Angeles County Museum of Art www.lacma.org, Public domain, via Wikimedia Commons)The spearhead was a piece of metal, usually iron or bronze, attached to the end of the spear (see 2.5 Spear, lance<REALIA:2.5>). It was either placed over the end of the spear shaft like a sleeve or wedged into a split at the end of the spear shaft and secured by tying it with a cord. The spearhead was sharpened to a point.

Translation:

In both of the references the spearhead is mentioned because of its exceptional size (about 7 kilograms, 15–16 pounds). The spearhead of an average soldier weighed much less. It is possible, but less likely, that the Hebrew word *qayin* in 2SA 21:16 refers to the entire spear, including its iron head.